

Arix ALIMAGNIDOKPO

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Research Interests

- Natural Language Processing (NLP) for low-resource languages
- Machine Learning for agriculture, health, and education
- Ethical and Responsible Artificial Intelligence

Education

SEP. 2022 – DEC. 2025 (EXPECTED)

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science, specialization in Artificial Intelligence and Applications

University of Abomey-Calavi, Abomey-Calavi, Benin

- Student Representative for the AI cohort (2022–2025)

2016 – 2022

Scientific Baccalaureate, Stream D, with Honors

Collège Catholique Père Aupiais, Cotonou, Benin

Professional & Research Experience

MAY 2025 – DEC. 2025

AI Developer & Project Manager

Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Benin (diplomatie.gouv.bj), Cotonou, Benin

- Led an internal strategic intelligence monitoring tool integrating artificial intelligence (NLP, LLMs).
- Responsible for model security, software and AI architecture, mitigation of hallucinations, and AI reliability.

AUG. 2024 – APR. 2025

Power BI Data Analyst Intern

Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Benin (diplomatie.gouv.bj), Cotonou, Benin

- Implemented Power BI dashboards for data visualization and monitoring.
- Notable projects:
 - Public Services Platform for the Beninese diaspora ([link](#)): tracked request volumes and processing times.
 - Tradux (tradux.gouv.bj): monitored translation requests, delays, and revenue, with actionable recommendations.

JUN. 2024 – AUG. 2024

Data Scientist Intern

ICT Consulting (ict-consulting.tech), Godomey, Benin

- Contributed to prototyping the FarmAdvisor project (farmadvisor.bj), an AI-based decision-support solution for farmers.
- Structured the database, facilitated IoT sensor data collection, and implemented an AI model.

Honors & Awards

MAY 2024

2nd Place, Multimodal and Multilingual AI Challenge Hackathon

Digital Entrepreneurship and Artificial Intelligence Week (SENIA) 2024

- Developed “Alodometo,” a solution for digital inclusion of illiterate populations via the Fon language.
- Contributed to a multimodal AI module for French–Fon translation (text, image, audio).
- (Article: [link](#), Prototype: [link](#))

JAN. 2024

Winner (1st Place), Teckbot Robotics Challenge 2024

With the Sèmè City Open Park team ([Sèmè City](#))

- Developed an autonomous robot for waste collection and sorting.
- Implemented a computer vision model for navigation, bin/color detection, and sorting.
- (Website: trc.tekbot.io, Video: [link](#))

DEC. 2023

Winner (1st Place), Deep Learning IndabaX Benin Hackathon 2023

- Created a medical appointment scheduling app with a chatbot and an AI system for severity assessment and prioritization.
- Collaborated with a final-year medical student (Faculty of Health Sciences, Benin).

Research Funding & Grants

OCT. 2024 – MAY 2025

Project Lead (Pôle Sud, Benin)

Project: Automatic Defense Scheduling System under Constraints at the University of Abomey-Calavi.

- Funded by ARES – Belgium (€20,000).
- Used constraint programming to manage jury availability, room allocation, and jury composition.
- (Report: [link](#))

Teaching Experience

JAN. 2024 – MAY 2025

AI Instructor

AI and Internet of Things Club, IFRI, University of Abomey-Calavi, Cotonou, Benin

- Member and coordinator; organized weekly AI and Machine Learning workshops for club members.

MAR. 2024 – MAY 2025

Instructor on AI Tools and Applications in Diplomacy

Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Benin (diplomatie.gouv.bj), Cotonou, Benin

- Designed and delivered an eight-session training module for the Directorate of External Relations staff.
- Covered AI tools, benefits for diplomacy, risks, and case studies.

Invited Presentations & Conferences

NOV. 2024

Project Presentation, Benin Workshop on Artificial Intelligence 2024

Cotonou, Benin

- Title: Development of a Voice Translation Model for Documents into Local Languages (Case Study: Fon gbé).
- (Presentation: [link](#))

SEP. 2024

Attendee, Deep Learning Indaba 2024

Dakar, Senegal

- Participated in Africa's largest AI conference; engaged with global and African experts.

Community & Volunteer Activities

FEB. 2025 – PRESENT

Volunteer

Benin Summer Maths Camps (IMAC Benin Association Initiative)

- Contributed to an intensive math camp for middle school students, introducing new technologies.

SEP. 2023 – PRESENT

Developer (IT Department) & Communications Member

Ratheil Foundation for Responsible and Efficient AI in Africa (FRIARE Africa) (friare.org)

- Participated in project development and communications activities for responsible AI in Africa.

OCT. 2023 – PRESENT

Training Commission Coordinator

Isheero (Benin AI Community) (isheero.com)

- Planned, organized, and delivered training programs and workshops for the community.

MAR. 2025

Reviewer for Applications

Deep Learning Indaba 2025, Kigali, Rwanda

Open Source Projects

Tomato Leaf Disease Detection Application (Computer Vision)

- Used YOLOv8 for foliar disease identification.

Intelligent Chatbot for Public Services Access in Benin (RAG)

- Employed Retrieval Augmented Generation technology.

Medical Application for Chronic Kidney Disease Stage Prediction (CKD)

Certifications

- Machine Learning Specialization – Stanford Online, DeepLearning.AI
- Natural Language Processing Specialization (NLP) – DeepLearning.AI
- Data Science Professional Certificate – IBM

Technical Skills

Programming Languages: Python (Advanced), JavaScript, PHP, C, C++

ML/DL Frameworks & Libraries: PyTorch, TensorFlow, HuggingFace Transformers, Scikit-learn

Web Frameworks: Django, ReactJS, Laravel

AI Expertise: Natural Language Processing (NLP), Large Language Models (LLMs), Computer Vision, Recommendation Systems, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), Constraint Programming,

Data Analysis

Tools & Platforms: Docker, Git/GitHub, MySQL, MongoDB, Power BI.

Languages

French: Native

Fon: Native

English: Intermediate